“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 1

A Brief Description of the Madhya-līlā

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 May the Lord Śrī Caitanyadeva be fully gracious to me — He by whose grace even an ignorant person at once becomes all-knowing.

2 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Śrī Nityānanda, who are like a wonderful sun and moon. They have risen together on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa, dispelling the darkness and bestowing good on all.[1]

3 All glory to the merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Madana-mohana! I am lame and dull of mind, and They are my only refuge; Their lotus feet are all I have.[2]

4 I remember Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrī Govindadeva, seated on a throne in a beautiful temple of jewels beneath a wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana, served by Their dearest companions.[3]

5 May the beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha, who begins the sweet rāsa dance, be our good fortune. Standing on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa, He draws the gopīs to Himself with the sounds of His flute.[4]

6 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to the ocean of mercy! Glory, glory to the son of Śacī! Glory to the friend of the fallen!

7 Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory, glory to all the devotees of Gaura, headed by Śrīvāsa!

8 Earlier I told the sūtras (brief threads) of the Ādi-līlā, which Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in full.

9 Therefore I gave only the sūtras of it; whatever particulars there were, I told within the sūtras themselves.

10 Now I shall tell the main sūtras of the final pastimes (Śeṣa-līlā). The Lord's pastimes are endless; they cannot be fully described.

11 Of these, the portion that Vṛndāvana dāsa described in detail in his *Caitanya-maṅgala* —

12 — of that portion I shall write here only the sūtras, and whatever special things were told there only in passing I shall describe here in full.[5]

13 Vṛndāvana dāsa is the Vyāsa of Śrī Caitanya's pastimes. By his order I merely partake of the remnants of his meal.[6]

14 With devotion I hold his feet upon my head, and now I describe the sūtras of the final pastimes.

15 For twenty-four years the Lord lived at home; the pastimes He showed there are known as the Ādi-līlā.

16 At the close of His twenty-fourth year, in the bright fortnight of the month of Māgha, the Lord accepted sannyāsa.

17 After taking sannyāsa He remained for twenty-four years; the pastimes of that time are called the Śeṣa-līlā.

18 The Śeṣa-līlā has two names, ‘Madhya’ (middle) and ‘Anta’ (final): the Vaiṣṇavas name it differently according to the difference in its pastimes.

19 Six of those years He spent journeying to and fro — from Nīlācala to Gauḍa, to Setubandha, to Vṛndāvana, and back again.[7]

20 The pastimes of that period are called the Madhya-līlā; the pastimes after it are named the Antya-līlā.

21 Thus there are the Ādi-līlā, the Madhya-līlā and the Antya-līlā. Now I shall expand somewhat on the Madhya-līlā.

22 For eighteen years He stayed only at Nīlācala. Practising devotion Himself, He taught it to the living beings.

23 For six of those years, in the joy of dancing and singing with His devotees, He spread loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*).[8]

24 He sent Nityānanda Gosāñi to Gauḍa, and Nityānanda flooded the whole land with the nectar of love.

25 Nityānanda is by nature unrestrained in love for Kṛṣṇa, and by the Lord’s order He gave that love away everywhere.

26 I offer millions of obeisances at the feet of Him who is dear to Caitanya and who made the whole world accept Him.[9]

27 He whom Caitanya Gosāñi calls His “elder brother” says, “My Lord is Caitanya Gosāñi.”

28 Although He Himself is Lord Balarāma, He still regards Himself as Caitanya’s servant.

29 He would say: “Serve Caitanya! Sing of Caitanya! Take Caitanya’s name! Whoever is devoted to Caitanya is My very life.”

30 In this way He made people take up devotion to Caitanya and delivered everyone — the wretched, the lowly and even blasphemers.

31 Then the Lord sent Rūpa and Sanātana to Vraja, and by His order the two brothers came to Vṛndāvana.

32 Preaching devotion, they revealed all the holy places and spread the service of Madana-gopāla and Govinda.

33 Gathering many scriptures, they composed books of devotion that are their essence, and so delivered foolish and fallen people.

34 By the Lord’s order they examined all the scriptures and preached the confidential devotion of Vraja.

35 *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, Bhāgavatāmṛta, Daśama-ṭippanī* and *Daśama-carita* —

36 all these books Sanātana Gosāñi composed. And who can count all that Rūpa Gosāñi composed?

37 I shall name some of the principal ones. In a hundred thousand verses he described the pastimes of Vraja.

38 *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Vidagdha-mādhava, Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* and *Lalita-mādhava*;

39 *Dāna-keli-kaumudī*, many hymns (*Stavāvalī*), the eighteen *Līlā-cchandas* and *Padyāvalī*;

40 *Govinda-virudāvalī* with its *lakṣaṇa* (definitions), *Mathurā-māhātmya* and *Nāṭaka-varṇana*.[10]

41 Who can count *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* and the rest? Everywhere in them he described the pastimes of Vraja.

42 His nephew is named Śrī Jīva Gosāñi. There is no end to the books of devotion he composed.

43 In his extensive work, the *Śrī Bhāgavata-sandarbha*, he has written the essence of the conclusions of devotion.[11]

44 In his renowned *Gopāla-campū*, full of the rasa of Vraja, he established the eternity of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes.

45 In this way they brought out many books and lived in Vṛndāvana together with their community.

46 In the first year after His sannyāsa the devotees headed by Advaita went to Nīlādri to see the Lord.

47 Having seen the Ratha-yātrā, they stayed there for four months, dancing and singing with the Lord in supreme joy.

48 When they took leave, the Lord told them all, "Come every year, all of you, to see the Guṇḍicā festival."

49 By the Lord's order the devotees came every year, saw the Guṇḍicā festival, met the Lord and went back.

50 For twelve years they came and went like this; neither the Lord nor His devotees could live without each other.

51 In the twelve years that remained at the end, the Lord's heart was filled with the pastimes of separation from Kṛṣṇa.

52 Night and day, in the divine madness of separation, He laughed, wept, danced and sang in great sorrow.

53 Whenever He took darśana of Jagannātha, He thought, "I have found Him again at Kurukṣetra."

54 When He danced in front of the chariot at the Ratha-yātrā, He sang only this song:

55 "I have found that very Lord of My life for whom I was wasting away, burning in the fire of Madana (love)."

56 To this refrain He danced through the second *prahara* (watch) of the day, and in His heart was one feeling: "I am taking Kṛṣṇa back to Vraja."

57 In this mood, in the midst of the dance, He recited a verse whose meaning none of the people understood:

58 "He who stole My heart in My girlhood is now My lord. These are the same moonlit nights of Caitra, and the same full breezes blow from the kadamba groves, fragrant with blossoming *mālatī*. I too am the same. Yet My heart yearns for Our play of love there, beneath the *vetasī* trees on the bank of the Revā." (Padyāvalī, 386)[12]

59 Svarūpa alone knew the meaning of this verse. By providence, that year Rūpa had come there.

60 Hearing the verse from the Lord's own lips, Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi then and there composed a verse that revealed its hidden meaning.

61 Having composed the verse and written it on a palm leaf, he tucked it into the thatched roof of his dwelling.

62 Leaving the verse there, he went to bathe in the sea, and at that very time the Lord came to meet him.

63 Haridāsa Ṭhākura, Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana — these three did not go into the temple of Jagannātha.

64 After seeing Jagannātha's *upala-bhoga* offering, Mahāprabhu would meet these three and then go to His own residence.

65 Whichever of the three was there at the time, the Lord would come and meet him Himself — this was His rule.

66 When the Lord came and by chance looked up, He found that verse on the palm leaf tucked into the thatch.

67 Having read the verse, the Lord stood absorbed in ecstasy. Rūpa Gosāñi came up and fell flat before Him in obeisance.

68 Mahāprabhu rose, gave him an affectionate slap, took him in His arms and began to speak:[13]

69 "No one knows the intent of My verse. How did you know what was in My mind?"

70 Saying this, He showed him great favour, and then took the verse and showed it to Svarūpa Gosāñi.

71 Astonished, the Lord asked Svarūpa, "How did Rūpa know what is in My mind?"

72 Svarūpa said, “That he knew Your mind tells me he has received Your mercy.”

73 The Lord said, “Pleased with him, I embraced him and infused all potencies into him.

74 He is a worthy vessel for understanding the hidden rasa, and you too should instruct him in its secrets.”

75 All this I shall tell later in detail; here, finding the occasion, I have mentioned it briefly.

76 “My dear companion, this is that same beloved Kṛṣṇa, met again at Kurukṣetra, and I am that same Rādhā; this is the same joy of Our union. Yet My heart longs for the forest on the bank of the Kālindī, which delights in the sweet fifth note of His flute playing in its depths.” (Padyāvalī, 387)[14]

77 Hear, O devotees, the brief meaning of this verse — how the Lord felt on seeing Jagannātha.

78 Although Śrī Rādhikā obtains the sight of Kṛṣṇa at Kurukṣetra, She still thinks:

79 “Royal dress, elephants, horses and crowds of people! Where is His cowherd dress, where is secluded Vṛndāvana?

80 When I find again that mood, that Kṛṣṇa and that Vṛndāvana, then My desire will be fulfilled.”

81 (The gopīs said:) “O Lord whose navel is like a lotus, the masters of yoga, whose wisdom is fathomless, meditate within their hearts on Your lotus feet, the support by which souls fallen into the well of worldly life are

lifted out. May those feet always rise in our minds too, though we are busy with our homes." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.48)[15]

82 "If Your feet should appear in My home in Vraja, then My desire will be fulfilled."[16]

83 Having considered the meaning of this verse of the *Bhāgavata*, Rūpa Gosāñi composed a verse that explains it to people.

84 (Śrī Rādhā said:) "Your blessed land of Vraja shines, encircled by the charms of the Mathurā country and by forests that breathe the fragrance of the nectar of Your pastimes. There, surrounded by us, whose hearts are enchanted by the mood of playful cowherd girls, take up Your play with the flute that sounds so joyfully at Your lips." (Lalita-mādhava, 10.38)[17]

85 Thus, when Mahāprabhu looked at Jagannātha, He saw Him with Subhadrā and with no flute in His hand.

86 "Where in Vraja shall I find the son of the king of Vraja, beautiful in His threefold bending?" — this was His constant desire.

87 Just as Rādhikā fell into divine madness on seeing Uddhava, so the Lord, night and day, spoke in the bewildered raving (*udghūrṇā*) of that madness.

88 Thus He passed the last twelve years. In this way I have set out the arrangement of the final pastimes.

89 Whatever He did during the twenty-four years after taking sannyāsa is endless and boundless — who can know its inner meaning?

90 To give some indication, I shall only point the way and list the sūtras of the principal pastimes.

91 The first sūtra is the Lord's acceptance of sannyāsa. Having taken sannyāsa, the Lord set out for Śrī Vṛndāvana.

92 Overwhelmed by love, with no awareness of the outer world, He wandered for three days in Rāḍha-deśa.

93 Nityānanda Prabhu beguiled Mahāprabhu and led Him to the bank of the Gaṅgā, calling it the Yamunā.

94 He came to the Ācārya's house in Śāntipura; there He took His first *bhikṣā* (meal as a sannyāsī), and at night there was saṅkīrtana.

95 There He met His mother and the devotees, and having settled everything, He left for Nīlādri.

96 On the way there were many pastimes: darśana of all the Deities, the story of Mādhava Purī and the installation of Gopāla.[18]

97 There was also the story of the theft of sweet rice and the account of Sākṣi-gopāla; and Nityānanda broke the Lord's staff.[19]

98 Angered, He went alone to see Jagannātha; on seeing Him, He fell unconscious to the ground.

99 Sārvabhauma took Him to his own house, and the Lord did not regain consciousness until the third *prahara* of the day, after noon.

100 Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Dāmodara and Mukunda came afterwards, met Him, and all rejoiced.

101 Then the Lord showed mercy to Sārvabhauma and revealed to him His own form as the Lord.

102 Then the Lord set out for the South. At Kūrma-kṣetra He delivered Vāsudeva.

103 At Jiyaḍa-nṛsiṁha He offered prayers to Nṛsiṁha, and on every road and in every village He established the chanting of the holy name.

104 The forest on the bank of the Godāvarī seemed to Him to be Vṛndāvana, and right there He met Rāmānanda Rāya.

105 He visited the holy places of Trimalla and Tripadī, and everywhere He spread the name of Kṛṣṇa.

106 Then He subdued the unbelievers, and He had darśana of Ahovala-nṛsiṁha and other Deities.[20]

107 He came to Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra on the bank of the Kāverī, and on seeing Śrī Raṅga He was overwhelmed with love.

108 The Lord lived in the house of Trimalla Bhaṭṭa and stayed there for the four months of the rains.

109 Trimalla Bhaṭṭa, a Śrī-vaiṣṇava, was a great scholar, and he was astonished at the Gosāñi's learning and love.

110 Mahāprabhu passed the *Cāturmāsya* with the Śrī-vaiṣṇavas in dancing, singing and the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name.

111 After the Cāturmāsya He again went south, and there He met Paramānanda Purī.

112 Then came the rescue of Kṛṣṇadāsa from the Bhaṭṭathāris, and the spreading of Kṛṣṇa's name through the mouths of brāhmaṇas who chanted Rāma's name.

113 There He met Śrī Raṅga Purī, and He relieved the sorrow of the brāhmaṇa Rāmadāsa.

114 He discussed the truth with the Tattvavādīs, and they all came to see their own understanding as inferior.

115 He had darśana of Ananta, Puruṣottama, Śrī Janārdana, Padmanābha and Vāsudeva.

116 Then the Lord liberated the seven palm trees (Sapta-tāla), bathed at Setubandha and had darśana of Rāmeśvara.

117 There He heard the *Kūrma Purāṇa*, in which it is written that Rāvaṇa carried off an illusory Sītā (*māyā-sītā*).

118 Hearing this, the Lord was delighted at heart, and He remembered the words of the brāhmaṇa Rāmadāsa.

119 He eagerly took that ancient leaf, showed it to Rāmadāsa and dispelled his sorrow.

120 He found two manuscripts, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* and the *Karṇāmṛta*, and knowing them to be excellent, He brought the two books back with Him.

121 Then He returned once more to Nīlācala, met the devotees and saw the Snāna-yātrā (the bathing festival).

122 During *anavasara*, unable to see Jagannātha, He went to Ālālanātha in the pain of separation.

123 He stayed there a few days with the devotees, and then received news that the devotees of Gauḍa were coming.

124 Nityānanda and Sārvabhauma pressed Him and brought Mahāprabhu back to Nīlācala.

125 The Lord passed His nights and days overwhelmed by separation. At that time the devotees of Gauḍa arrived.

126 They all gathered, took counsel and began kīrtana; absorbed in the kīrtana, the Lord's mind grew calm.

127 Earlier, when the Lord met Rāmānanda, He had ordered him to come to Nīlācala.

128 Taking the king's permission, he came some days later, and night and day the Lord talked about Kṛṣṇa with Rāmānanda.

129 He showed mercy to Kāśī Miśra and met Pradyumna Miśra and others; Paramānanda Purī, Govinda and Kāśīśvara arrived.

130 Meeting Svarūpa Dāmodara brought Him supreme joy; He also met Śikhi Māhiti and Bhavānanda Rāya.

131 All the Vaiṣṇavas came from Gauḍa, and there was the first meeting with the residents of Kulīna-grāma.

132 All the residents of Khaṇḍa, headed by Narahari Dāsa, came with Śivānanda Sena and met the Lord.

133 After seeing the Snāna-yātrā with the devotees, the Lord took them all and cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple.

134 With everyone He saw the Ratha-yātrā; He danced before the chariot and then went to a garden.

135 In that place He showed mercy to Pratāparudra. On the day of farewell He gave the devotees of Gauḍa an order:

136 "Come every year to see the Ratha-yātrā." In this way He sought to meet His devotees again and again.

137 Then there was the splendid meal for the Lord at Sārvabhauma's house, because of which Ṣāṭhī's mother said, "Let Ṣāṭhī become a widow!"[21]

138 The next year the devotees headed by Advaita came once more, setting out together to see the Lord.

139 The Lord joyfully gave them all lodging, and Śivānanda Sena took care of everyone.[22]

140 A fortunate dog came with Śivānanda; having seen the Lord's feet, it vanished from this world.

141 On the way they all met Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, who was going on to Kāśī.

142 All the Vaiṣṇavas came and met the Lord, and the Lord sported in the water with them all.

143 Taking everyone, He cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple, and at the Ratha-yātrā the Lord danced.

144 In the gardens the Lord enjoyed various pastimes, and the brāhmaṇa Kṛṣṇadāsa performed His ceremonial bath (*abhiṣeka*).[23]

145 At Guṇḍicā, after dancing, He played in the water, and on Herā-pañcamī He watched the pastime of the goddess Lakṣmī.

146 At the festival of Kṛṣṇa's birth the Lord dressed as a cowherd; He carried a yoke laden with pots of yogurt and then twirled a staff.

147 Then He bade farewell to the devotees of Gauḍa, and with the devotees who stayed with Him He held kīrtana constantly.

148 Intending to go to Vṛndāvana, He set out for Gauḍa, and on the way Pratāparudra served Him in many ways.

149 Then came the episode of the gift of cloth with Purī Gosāñi, and Rāmānanda Rāya accompanied Him as far as Bhadraka.

150 Arriving in Bengal, He stayed in the house of Vidyā-vācaspati, and crowds of people gathered to see Him.

151 For five days people kept coming to see Him without pause; to escape the crowds, the Lord went at night to the village of Kuliyā.

152 Hearing that the Lord had come to Kuliyā, millions upon millions of people came to see Him.

153 In Kuliyā He showed His grace to Devānanda and forgave the brāhmaṇa Gopāla his offence against Śrīvāsa.[24]

154 Unbelievers and blasphemers came and fell at His feet; He forgave their offences and gave them love for Kṛṣṇa.

155 When Nṛsiṁhānanda heard that the Lord would go to Vṛndāvana, he joyfully decorated the road in his mind.

156 From the town of Kuliyā he paved the road with jewels and spread over it a bed of flowers with their stems removed.

157 On both sides of the road stood rows of flowering *bakula* trees, and here and there on either side lay divine ponds.

158 Their bathing steps were set with jewels, and lotuses bloomed in them; many birds chattered, and the water was like nectar.

159 A cool breeze blew, bearing many fragrances. Thus he paved the road as far as Kānāi's Nāṭaśālā.

160 Beyond that point his mind could not go, nor could he pave any further; the road came to a halt, and Nṛsiṁhānanda was astonished.

161 "I tell you with certainty — listen, O devotees: this time the Lord will not go to Śrī Vṛndāvana.

162 He will turn back from Kānāi's Nāṭaśālā. You will see it later; I have said this with certainty."[25]

163 The Lord set out from Kuliyā for Vṛndāvana, and thousands of people went with Him, all of them devotees.

164 Wherever the Lord went, people came by the millions to see Him, and seeing Him, they were freed from sorrow and grief.

165 Wherever the Lord's feet touched the ground as He walked, people took away that earth, leaving pits in the road.

166 Walking on in this way, the Lord came to Rāmakeli, a village of incomparable beauty near Gauḍa.[26]

167 There the Lord danced, losing outer consciousness in love, and millions upon millions of people came to see His feet.

168 Hearing of His power, the Muslim king who ruled Gauḍa was amazed and said:

169 "One whom so many people follow without being given anything is surely a holy master (*gosāñi*). Know this for certain.

170 Let no kazi or any other Muslim trouble Him. Let Him go wherever He pleases."[27]

171 The king asked Keśava Chatrī for news of Him, but Chatrī brushed aside the Lord's greatness:[28]

172 "He is a mendicant sannyāsī touring the holy places. Only a handful of people come to see Him.

173 Some Muslim has been slandering Him to you. You gain nothing by harming Him; rather, you would suffer loss."

174 Having pacified the king, Keśava sent a brāhmaṇa, who went and asked the Lord to leave.

175 Then the king questioned Dabira Khāsa in private, and he began to tell of the Lord's greatness:[29]

176 "He who gave you your kingdom, He who is your Lord, has come and taken birth in your country by your good fortune.

177 He desires your welfare, and His words come true; by His blessing you will be victorious everywhere.[30]

178 Why do you ask me? Ask your own heart. As a ruler of men you are like a part of Viṣṇu.[31]

179 Whatever understanding of Caitanya arises in your heart — whatever your heart accepts — that is the proof."

180 The king said: "Listen to what my heart accepts: He is God Himself. Of this there is no doubt."

181 Saying this, the king withdrew to his inner apartments, and Dabira Khāsa returned to his own house.

182 At home the two brothers took counsel together and went in disguise to see the Lord.

183 At midnight the two brothers came to where the Lord was staying. First they met Nityānanda and Haridāsa.

184 These two told the Lord: "Rūpa and Sākara Mallika have come to see You."[32]

185 Holding bunches of straw between their teeth and with cloths tied around their necks, the two brothers fell flat like rods.

186 They wept in humility, overwhelmed with joy. The Lord said, "Rise, rise! Good fortune has come to you."

187 Rising, the two brothers, still holding straw between their teeth, humbly offered prayers with joined palms:

188 “Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the merciful! Glory to the saviour of the fallen! Glory to the magnanimous Lord!

189 We are low-born, we keep low company and do low work; O Lord, we are ashamed even to speak before You.[33]

190 “There is no sinner like me, nor any offender like me. O Puruṣottama, I am ashamed even to ask forgiveness; what more can I say?” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.154)[34]

191 You descended to deliver the fallen, and in all the world there are none more fallen than we.

192 You delivered the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhāi, but delivering them cost You no effort.

193 They were brāhmaṇas by birth and lived in Navadvīpa. They did not serve low people, nor were they the ‘elbow’ — the ready tool — of low men.

194 Their only fault was sinful conduct, and even the semblance of Your name (*nāmābhāsa*) burns up heaps of sin.[35]

195 They uttered Your name while blaspheming You, and that very name became the cause of their liberation.

196 We two are millions of times lower, more fallen and more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhāi.

197 We are mlecchas by birth, keep the company of mlecchas and do the deeds of mlecchas; we associate with the enemies of cows and brāhmaṇas.[36]

198 My own deeds have bound me by the hands and neck and thrown me into the filthy pit of wicked sense enjoyment.[37]

199 No one in the three worlds is strong enough to deliver us — none but You, the saviour of the fallen.

200 If You show Your strength by delivering us, then Your name "Saviour of the Fallen" will be fulfilled.

201 I tell You one true thing — listen, O merciful Lord: in all the world there is no one so fit for mercy as I.

202 Show me mercy and so make Your name "Merciful" come true; let the whole universe see the power of Your mercy.[38]

203 "Hear one plea I lay before You, O Lord; it is no lie, but the very truth: if You will not show me mercy, You will hardly find anyone more fit to receive it." (Stotra-ratna, 47)[39]

204 Seeing my own unworthiness, I am distressed at heart; yet Your qualities awaken longing in me.

205 As a dwarf wishes to catch the moon, so this desire rises in my heart.

206 "When, O Lord, serving You alone without cease, with every other desire completely stilled, shall I live as Your wholly devoted eternal servant and fill my life with joy?" (Stotra-ratna, 43)[40]

207 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu said: "Listen, Dabira Khāsa: you two brothers are My servants of old.[41]

208 From today your names are Rūpa and Sanātana. Give up this humility — your humility breaks My heart.[42]

209 Time and again you wrote Me humble letters, and through those letters I came to know your ways.

210 Through those letters I knew your hearts, and to instruct you I quoted a verse again and again:

211 "A woman attached to a man other than her husband may seem busy with her household duties, but within she relishes only the nectar of new meetings with him."[43]

212 I had no reason to come near Gauḍa; I came here only to see you two.

213 No one knows the secret of My heart; everyone asks why I have come to Rāmakeli.

214 It is good that you two brothers came to Me. Now go home and do not be afraid.

215 Birth after birth you two are My servants. Very soon Kṛṣṇa will deliver you."

216 Saying this, He placed His two hands on their heads, and the two brothers took the Lord's feet and set them on their heads.

217 Embracing them both, the Lord said to the devotees: "All of you, be merciful and deliver these two."

218 Seeing the Lord's mercy on the two, all the devotees joyfully called out, "Hari! Hari!"

219 Nityānanda, Haridāsa, Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara, Mukunda, Jagadānanda, Murāri and Vakreśvara were there.

220 The two brothers fell at the feet of each of them, and all said: “You are blessed — you have attained the Lord.”

221 Asking leave of everyone, at the time of departure they bowed at the Lord’s feet and humbly said:[44]

222 “Leave this place, O Lord; there is nothing for You here. True, the king of Gauḍa shows You devotion.

223 Yet he is a Muslim by birth — do not trust him. And such a crowd is not the proper way to go on pilgrimage.

224 To travel to Vṛndāvana followed by hundreds of thousands of people is not fitting.”

225 Although in truth the Lord has nothing to fear, His pastimes in this world follow the ways of ordinary people.[45]

226 Saying this, the two saluted His feet and left, and the Lord resolved to leave that village.

227 Setting out in the morning, the Lord came to Kānāi’s Nāṭaśālā, and there He saw depicted all the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa.[46]

228 That night the Lord pondered within Himself: “Sanātana says it is not good to travel with a crowd.

229 If I go to Mathurā with so many people, there will be no happiness in it; the rasa will be spoiled.

230 I shall go alone, or with just one companion; only then will My journey to Vṛndāvana be beautiful."

231 Thinking this, Gaurahari bathed in the Gaṅgā in the morning and set out, saying, "I shall go to Nīlācala."

232 Walking on in this way He came to Śāntipura and stayed five or seven days at the Ācārya's house.

233 Śacīdevī came and offered Him her obeisance, and for seven days He took His meals from her.

234 Taking her permission, He set out again, and He humbly bade the devotees farewell:[47]

235 "I shall go to Nīlācala with two companions. Come and meet Me at the time of the Ratha-yātrā."

236 With two companions — Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya and Dāmodara Paṇḍita — the Lord came to Nīlācala.

237 After staying there a few days He set out for Vṛndāvana, leaving secretly at night without anyone knowing.

238 Only Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya stayed with Him. By the forest road of Jhārikhaṇḍa He came to Kāśī, enjoying many wonderful pastimes on the way.

239 After staying four days in Kāśī He went to Vṛndāvana; having seen Mathurā, He visited the twelve forests.[48]

240 Seeing the places of the pastimes, He became overwhelmed with love, and Balabhadra led Him away from Mathurā.

241 Taking Him along the road beside the Gaṅgā, Balabhadra came to Prayāga, and there Śrī Rūpa came and met the Lord.

242 Rūpa fell to the ground in obeisance, and the Lord embraced him in supreme joy.

243 Having instructed Śrī Rūpa, He sent him to Vṛndāvana, and He Himself came to Vārāṇasī.

244 In Kāśī Sanātana came and met the Lord, who stayed two months and instructed him.

245 He sent him to Mathurā, investing him with the strength of bhakti; then, after showing mercy to the sannyāsī, He went to Nīlācala.[49]

246 For six years the Lord enjoyed such pastimes, sometimes wandering here and there, sometimes living in the Kṣetra (Purī).

247 With the devotees He always delighted in kīrtana, beheld Jagannātha and revelled in love.

248 Thus I have given the Madhya-līlā in brief sūtras. Now, O devotees, hear the sūtras of the Antya-līlā.

249 After He returned from Vṛndāvana to Nīlācala, He lived there eighteen years and went nowhere else.[50]

250 Every year the devotees of Gauḍa came there and stayed four months in the Lord's company.

251 Constantly He sang and danced in the joy of kīrtana, and revealed loving devotion (prema-bhakti) to all, even to the caṇḍālas.

252 Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosāñi lived in Nīlācala, as did Vakreśvara, Dāmodara, Śaṅkara and Haridāsa.[51]

253 Jagadānanda, Bhavānanda, Govinda, Kāśīśvara, Paramānanda Purī and Svarūpa Dāmodara lived there too.[52]

254 Rāmānanda Rāya and the other residents of the Kṣetra all remained constantly with the Lord.

255–256 Advaita, Nityānanda, Mukunda, Śrīvāsa, Vidyānidhi, Vāsudeva, Murāri and all His other servants came together every year and stayed four months, and with them the Lord enjoyed many kinds of pastimes.

257 Haridāsa's attainment of perfection was wonderful in every way, and Mahāprabhu Himself held a great festival in his honour.[53]

258 Then Rūpa Gosāñi came again, and the Lord infused His power into his heart.[54]

259 Then the Lord punished Choṭa Haridāsa, and Dāmodara Paṇḍita "punished" the Lord with words.[55]

260 Then Sanātana Gosāñi came again, and in the month of Jyaiṣṭha the Lord tested him.

261 Pleased with him, the Lord sent him to Vṛndāvana. Then came the Lord's wonderful meal from Advaita's own hand.

262 After consulting Nityānanda in private, He sent Him to Gauḍa to preach prema.

263 Then Vallabha Bhaṭṭa met the Lord, and the Lord explained to him the meaning of Kṛṣṇa's name.

264 Telling Pradyumna Miśra of Rāmānanda's qualities, the Lord had him hear talks about Kṛṣṇa from Rāmānanda.[56]

265 Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka, Rāmānanda's brother, was about to be put to death by the king, and the Lord became his saviour.

266 For fear of Rāmacandra Purī He cut down His meals, but seeing the Vaiṣṇavas' sorrow He kept to half His former portion.

267 Within the universe are fourteen worlds, and in them dwell countless living beings.[57]

268 All of them took human form and came to Nīlācala in the guise of pilgrims to see the Lord.

269 One day Śrīvāsa and all the other devotees held kīrtana, singing of Mahāprabhu's qualities.

270 Hearing this, the Lord spoke to the devotees in angry words: "Leaving aside Kṛṣṇa's names and qualities, what are you singing in your kīrtana?[58]

271 All of you have set your minds on insolence; acting independently, you will ruin the world!"

272 At that very time millions upon millions of people on all sides raised a tumult, crying, "Glory to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya!

273 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu, the son of the king of Vraja! O Lord, You have descended to deliver the world.

274 We have come from very far away in great distress. O Lord, grant us Your sight and fulfil our lives!”

275 Hearing the people’s humble plea, the merciful Lord’s heart melted; He came outside and let them see Him.

276 Raising His arms, the Lord said, “Say ‘Hari! Hari!’” — and the sound of Śrī Hari’s name arose, filling all four directions.

277 Seeing the Lord, the people were filled with love and joy; calling Him God, they offered Him praise.

278 Hearing their praise, Śrīnivāsa said to the Lord: “At home You stay hidden — why reveal Yourself outside?

279 Who taught these people? What are they saying? Cover all their mouths with Your own hand!

280 It is as if the sun, having risen, wished to hide. We cannot understand such behaviour of Yours.”

281 The Lord said: “Śrīnivāsa, stop this mockery. All of you together heap humiliation on Me.”[59]

282 Saying this, He bestowed His auspicious glance on the people and went inside, and the people’s desire was fulfilled.

283 Raghunātha dāsa went to Nityānanda and there held the festival of flat rice and yogurt.[60]

284 With Nityānanda’s permission he went to the Lord’s feet, and the Lord entrusted him to Svarūpa’s care.[61]

285 He made Brahmānanda Bhāratī give up his garment of skin. In this way He enjoyed His pastimes for six years.

286 Thus I have told the sūtras of the Madhya-līlā. Now hear the account of the last twelve years.[62]

287 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.2 and 1.84; translation as there. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.15; translation as there. Edition heading: “Obeisance to the Deity who presides over *sambandha* (the relationship with the Lord)”. *Anubhāṣya* (to Ādi 1.15): *manda-mati* — “a mind absorbed in the world, feeble, unable to follow other paths such as karma or jñāna”; *suratau* — “merciful”, or “deeply attached to each other”. ↩
3. The same verse as Ādi 1.16; translation as there. Edition heading: “Obeisance to the Deity who presides over *abhidheya* (the means)”. *Anubhāṣya* (to Ādi 1.16): *preṣṭhālī* — Lalitā and the other *priya-narma-sakhīs*, attended by Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī and others. ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.17; translation as there. Edition heading: “Obeisance to the Deity who presides over *prayojana* (the goal)”. *Anubhāṣya* (to Ādi 1.17): the flute “loosens every desire in the gopīs other than for Kṛṣṇa and draws them from their homes with the rope of prema”; *śriye* — “for the wealth of prema”. ↩
5. Edition heading (to 11–12): “A promise: the events described in detail in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* will be given as sūtras, and the chief events that are told there only briefly will be set out in detail.” ↩
6. The first line is the same as in Ādi 8.34 and 13.48. *Anubhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa Dvaipāyana Vyāsa wrote of the avatāras and of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes; Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, who wrote of Śrī Caitanya’s pastimes, is Vyāsa himself (*vyāsa-svarūpa*); Kṛṣṇadāsa writes of what he left untold as his servant and follower. ↩
7. The first line is the same as in Ādi 13.12; the second differs there (“now to the south, now to Gauḍa, now to Vṛndāvana”). Setubandha is the site of Rāma’s bridge near Rāmeśvaram (cf. 116). ↩

8. The first line is the same as in Ādi 13.38; in the second, Ādi 13.38 has *laoyāila* (“led people to take”), and this verse *pravartāila* (“spread, established”). ↩
9. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *caitanyera priya yiṅho* (“He who is dear to Caitanya”). Other editions read *caitanyera bhakti yeṅho* (“He who [made the world take] devotion to Caitanya”). ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *Govinda-virudāvalī* is part of the *Stava-mālā*; the *Nāṭaka-varṇana* is the *Nāṭaka-candrikā*. ↩
11. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (*bhakti-siddhānta tāte likhiyāchena sāra*). Other editions read *…dekhāiyāchena pāra* (“he has shown the utmost reach of the conclusions of devotion”). *Anubhāṣya*: the *Bhāgavata-sandarbha* is also called the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*, the six *Sandarbhas*. ↩
12. The verse is also found in the *Kāvya-prakāśa* (1.4), as the edition heading notes. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (to 59): it was composed about a worldly hero and heroine; why Mahāprabhu recited it with such love, no one but Svarūpa Dāmodara knew. ↩
13. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: some readings have *uhāi* for *uṭhi’* (“rising”). Edition heading: “The Lord’s unfeigned affection and mercy towards Rūpa”. ↩
14. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition prints *saṅgasukham*, a misprint that breaks the metre; the *Anubhāṣya* reads *saṅgama-sukham*. *Anubhāṣya*: the flute plays “within — in the depths of the heart, or in the midst of Vṛndā’s forest”. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: the gopīs spoke these words to Kṛṣṇa after meeting Him at Kurukṣetra (Syamantapañcaka); *gehaṁ juṣām* — “of us who dwell at home, in Vṛndāvana, devoted by nature to our household duties”: we are neither yogīs absorbed in meditation nor worldly people, but are sunk in the ocean of separation from You. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: some readings add here another verse, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.83.2. ↩
16. The pronoun is singular (*mora*, “My”): these are Rādhikā’s thoughts continued from 78–80, by which Mahāprabhu explains the verse. ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa offered Śrīmatī Rādhikā any boon She desired, and She answered with this verse; *kṣauṇī* — the land of Vraja. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: Mādhava Purī is Śrī Mādhavendra Purī. Edition heading: “On the way to Purī: the story of Mādhavendra Purī at Remuṇā, and darśana of Gopīnātha”. ↩
19. The verse does not say who tells the stories: the Lord Himself tells of Kṣīra-corā Gopīnātha (Madhya 4), and Nityānanda of Sākṣi-gopāla (Madhya 5). ↩
20. Edition heading: “The deliverance of the Buddhist unbelievers, and darśana of Nṛsiṁha at Ahovala”. ↩

21. Edition heading: “The Lord’s meal at Sārvabhauma’s house; the offence of his son-in-law Amogha, and his deliverance” (Madhya 15). ↩
22. Edition heading: “The Lord makes arrangements for everyone”. ↩
23. Edition heading: “The pastimes of the Lord absorbed in the mood of separation (*vipralambha*)”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *upavana* are the gardens on both sides of the Baḍa-daṇḍa, the road along which the chariot goes to the house of Guṇḍicā. ↩
24. *Anubhāṣya*: on the deliverance of Gopāla Cāpala, see Ādi 17.55–59. ↩
25. *Anubhāṣya*: Kānāi’s Nāṭaśālā lies about six miles from Rajmahal station (two miles from Taljhari). ↩
26. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Rāmakeli lies near Gauḍa on the bank of the Gaṅgā; Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana lived there at that time. ↩
27. Edition heading: “The padishah orders his official not to hinder the Lord from going wherever He wishes”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (to 168): the Muslim ruler of Gauḍa was the padishah Husain Shah. ↩
28. Edition heading: “The kṣatriya Keśava, wishing the Lord well, calms the padishah”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Keśava knew the truth about Mahāprabhu; fearing that the padishah, if he went on asking, would turn against the Lord, he did not let the conversation go further. ↩
29. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Dabira Khāsa was the name the Muslim king had given to Śrī Rūpa at that time. ↩
30. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *vākya siddha haya* (“His word comes true”). ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: of the king it is said, “For a great deity dwells in the form of a man” (*Manu-saṁhitā* 7.8). ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: just as Śrī Rūpa was then called Dabira Khāsa, Śrī Sanātana was known by the name the king had given him, Sākara Mallika. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: the brothers were born in a pure family of Karṇāṭa brāhmaṇas and speak so out of humility: serving a Muslim king, they had taken up the work of low people and so count themselves among them. ↩
34. Edition heading: the verse is cited in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (Pūrva-vibhāga, Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, 154). *Anubhāṣya*: *parihāre* — “when it comes to asking pardon for an offence”; “what shall I say” — I have no ground even to ask. ↩
35. Edition heading: “By *nāmābhāsa* alone their sins are burnt and they are delivered”. ↩
36. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: mlecchas are of two kinds — by birth and by association; the brothers call themselves mlecchas by association, keeping

company with those born mlecchas who are hostile to cows and brāhmaṇas. ↩

37. *Anubhāṣya*: all worldly enjoyment is of the nature of filth; as one who has fallen into a pit cannot climb out by his own will, so the soul absorbed in sense objects cannot, by his own strength, get out of the pit of worldly enjoyment. ↩
38. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *sadaya* (“Merciful”), with *sva-dayā* (“Your own mercy”) in brackets; the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* follows *sadaya*: “justify Your name *sadaya*, ‘the merciful’”. ↩
39. Edition heading: “(a verse by Śrī Yāmunācārya)”; in the edition the verse is printed without a number. *Anubhāṣya*: being the lowest of all, I am the fit vessel of mercy. ↩
40. Edition heading: “(a verse by Śrī Yāmunācārya)”. ↩
41. Edition heading: “The Lord’s merciful words to both brothers, addressed to Śrī Rūpa”. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: in His mercy Mahāprabhu named Dabira Khāsa “Rūpa” and Sākara Mallika “Sanātana”; for one on the path of rules the giving of a name is one of the saṁskāras, and those who disregard the name received by the grace of a Vaiṣṇava guru cannot hope for devotion to Hari. ↩
43. Edition heading: “The outward conduct of a devotee on the path of rāga”, with the note “[a verse spoken by Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya]”. *Anubhāṣya*: so too expert Vaiṣṇavas outwardly keep the prescribed duties of varṇāśrama, while all the art of their bhajana is service to Hari alone. ↩
44. Edition heading: “Sanātana gives the Lord good counsel at parting”. ↩
45. Edition heading: “Though He is the Supreme Lord Himself, in the role of ācārya He gives beginners (*kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*) a chance to learn”. ↩
46. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in those days a “Kānāi’s Nāṭaśālā” was set up in many places in Gauḍa; here, near Gauḍa, the Lord saw many pictures of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes. ↩
47. Edition heading: “The Lord takes leave of all the devotees and tells them to come to Purī for the Ratha-yātrā”. ↩
48. *Anubhāṣya*: the twelve forests are Kāmyavana, Tālavana, Tamālavana, Madhuvana, Kusumavana, Bhāṇḍīravana, Bilvavana, Bhadravana, Khadiravana, Lohavana, Kumudavana and Gokula-Mahāvana. ↩
49. Edition heading: “The Lord sends Sanātana to the Mathurā region and delivers Prakāśānanda”. ↩
50. Edition heading: “After the six years, the remaining eighteen years — living in Purī alone”. ↩
51. Edition heading: “Śrī Gadādhara’s vow to stay in the Kṣetra (*kṣetra-sannyāsa*), and the devotees who lived in Purī”. ↩

52. The second line is the same as Ādi 10.125. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *bhavānanda*: Bhavānanda Rāya, the father of Rāmānanda Rāya. ↩
53. *Anubhāṣya*: on the passing of Ṭhākura Haridāsa, see Antya, ch. 11. ↩
54. *Anubhāṣya*: this is the infusion of the *cit-śakti*, the transcendental potency; without it, or when the *māyā-śakti* is infused, only the inclination to enjoy grows (see Antya, ch. 1). ↩
55. *Anubhāṣya*: Dāmodara warned the Lord that the ignorant, not understanding Him, would criticise Him — this is the "punishment by words"; in the devotees' judgement these are only words that look like punishment (see Antya, chs. 2–3). ↩
56. Edition heading: "Rāya Rāmānanda, a Vaiṣṇava ācārya though not a brāhmaṇa by birth, is accepted as guru by Pradyumna Miśra, a brāhmaṇa by birth" (see Antya, ch. 5). ↩
57. Edition heading: "The deliverance of countless living beings of the universe through the sight of the Lord". ↩
58. Edition heading (to 269): "The Lord's reproach and show of anger because Śrīvāsa and the other devotees sing of Gaura, and His order to sing of Kṛṣṇa". ↩
59. Edition heading: "The Lord's embarrassment and His feigned reproach of Śrīvāsa". *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: some manuscripts read instead, "You do all that pains Me." ↩
60. Edition heading: "Śrī Raghunātha's service to Nityānanda and His associates at Pāṇihāṭi". ↩
61. Edition heading: "Then, by Nityānanda's mercy, Raghunātha leaves home, comes to the Lord's feet in Purī and surrenders himself to Dāmodara Svarūpa". The *Anubhāṣya* quotes Raghunātha's own verse (*Vilāpa-kusumāñjali* 5): with the ropes of His mercy Caitanya-candra drew him out of the well of household life, brought him to His feet and Himself gave him to Śrī Dāmodara. ↩
62. Edition heading: "Of the eighteen years, leaving aside six, the pastimes of the last twelve years will be described in sūtras later". *Anubhāṣya*: the author gives the sūtras of the last twelve years in the second chapter, and then describes the Madhya- and Antya-līlā step by step in detail (cf. Antya 1.10–11). ↩